

Dell has always been known for offering solutions online. I quickly logged on to Dell's site to look at what was on offer. The Inspiron Desktop is the most sensible solution for this kind of requirement. The processor used is also the Intel Core 2 Duo E5300. The graphics solution isn't great, but then it isn't going to be used in the office. One of the nice things is the included Windows 7 Home Basic. The prices for the Inspiron 545s start from Rs. 23,900. They can be customised to be built around faster processors and better graphics solutions, larger disk space and more memory. There's even the option to choose a slightly different colour panel!



HP Ideacentre A600

We also walked into a Lenovo showroom to see what we could find suitable for both home and office use. The IdeaCentre is one of the new ranges from Lenovo that come in a very user-friendly design. The A600 model looks like a TV at first. It comes with a wireless keyboard and the remote control is used to interact with the computer that's built into the display unit itself. There were different models even in this form factor. The power comes from Intel's T series mobile processors. Prices start from Rs. 48,880.

For more serious computing work in an office scenario, the traditional ThinkCentre A and M series are better suited. They are much cheaper than the Ideacentre A and Lenovo C series of desktops.

If you're looking to buy PCs in bulk and you can't afford the ones priced at Rs. 23,900, desktops from eSys might be worth considering. The desktop without the display are priced at some Rs. 21,000 for a basic quad core processor. Those based on the cheaper E5300 are nothing more than Rs. 13,490 which is almost Rs. 10,000 less than the ones from Acer and Dell.

On the gaming end, Dell seems like the ultimate solution. The recent acquisition of Alienware means these monster desktops are available to all of us in India. The Aurora starts from Rs. 1,25,000, which I agree is a lot of money. It's also one of the most flamboyant gaming rigs out there –